

Vestibule Field Guide: Orchard Operations

This field guide summarizes seasonal operating procedures for the northern orchard cooperative. It covers soil preparation, irrigation scheduling, and pest management practices used across all seventeen growing regions in the current growing season.

Soil Preparation

Before planting, soil pH is tested in each block and amended with dolomitic lime where acidity exceeds target thresholds. Cover crops are tilled under six weeks ahead of planting to improve organic matter content and reduce compaction from harvest equipment traffic.

Irrigation Scheduling

Drip irrigation lines are checked weekly for emitter clogging during the growing season. Watering schedules are adjusted using soil moisture sensors placed at root depth, targeting consistent moisture without waterlogging the root zone, especially during fruit set in early summer.

Pest Management

Pests are controlled primarily through integrated pest management: pheromone traps monitor codling moth populations weekly, and targeted biological controls such as predatory mites are released before resorting to any chemical treatment. Beneficial insect habitat is preserved along orchard borders to support natural predators.

Harvest Yields by Region

Region	2024 Yield (tons)	2025 Yield (tons)
Northgate Block	412	438
Millbrook Block	356	371
Cedar Hollow Block	289	305